History Week 5: So What? for money and work (written)

Ember · Rework your own paragraph · about 25 minutes Date: _____

Skill: So What? After every Evidence sentence, one more sentence: what did this make peasants **want**, or lords **fear**? Point back at the evidence. Evidence comes from the fact bank (S2–S8 on screen) or your notes.

Your paragraph from last week (socioeconomic change)

"One change in medieval england was that peasants got rich and they could afford rent and could move out. As a result, lots of villages and places in england were deserted. Lots of the community was dead so the lords who paid the peasants were forced to pay more if they wanted their workers to stay as many had dropped dead from the plague. They moved out of villages such as Serfdom and that village died out. This is an important change as it shows how the society in medieval england slowly began to collapse as the plague began to collect more victims and the richer side of society weren't as rich anymore."

Plan (5 min)

	Evidence, with a date (fact number)	**So what? What did peasants want, or lords fear?**
Evidence 1		
Evidence 2		

[6 marks]

Rewrite the paragraph. Keep your Point. Use S3 for Evidence 1 and S4 for Evidence 2 (or your own choices), each with a date and a So What. End with one sentence back to the question: how much did this change people's lives?

Claim check: is each claim in the fact bank?

Claim from your paragraph	Fact number, or “source needed”	Supported / check / source needed
“peasants got rich”		
“villages such as Serfdom”		
“society … slowly began to collapse”		
“the richer side of society weren’t as rich anymore”		

Self-check (5 min)

□ Point: one clear change, in one sentence.

□ Evidence 1 and Evidence 2 each have a date.

□ Each So What says what peasants wanted or lords feared, and points back.

□ The last sentence goes back to the question.

□ Capital letters for England, Germany and the Black Death.

□ Reflection: which So What was easiest to add? Which claim was hardest to back up?

What a strong reworked paragraph does (AQA Level 3: developed explanation)

- **Point:** e.g. “One major change after the Black Death was that working people gained more power over their own work.”
- **Evidence 1 + So What:** S3 with “from 1349”; then what peasants *wanted* (to be paid what their work was now worth, to choose their master).
- **Evidence 2 + So What:** S4 with “1349 and 1351”; then what lords *feared* (losing money and control).
- **Link:** how much life changed, and for whom. Careful with “collapse”: serfdom faded over 100 years, it did not collapse at once.

Claim check answers: “got rich”: check (S3 says higher wages, not rich; S8 says *some* had more money). “Villages such as Serfdom”: wrong, serfdom is a system (S6). “Society collapsed”: source needed (S6 says a slow change). “Richer side weren’t as rich”: check (S5 shows lords changing how they used land; it does not say they lost their wealth).

Written for Ember. Facts from the Black Death fact bank (checked against History Today and World History Encyclopedia articles). Format: a paragraph for AQA-style “explain” questions.